

As you are aware, we are committed to ensuring that every person we support is treated with compassion, respect and dignity. To reinforce this commitment, we are implementing the **FREDA principles** into our everyday practice.

FREDA stands for:

- **Fairness**
- **Respect**
- **Equality**
- **Dignity**
- **Autonomy**

These principles are based on human rights and should underpin every interaction you have with the people we support, their families, colleagues and other professionals.

What this means in your role

Fairness

Treat every person fairly and without discrimination. Provide care based on each individual's assessed needs, preferences and choices. Never allow personal opinions or assumptions to influence the care you provide.

Respect

Always speak to people politely and professionally. Listen to what they tell you, respect their wishes and involve them in decisions about their care. Respect people's beliefs, culture, religion, lifestyle and personal preferences.

Equality

Ensure everyone has equal access to the care and support they need. Make reasonable adjustments where required, including adapting your communication to meet the person's needs.

Dignity

Protect people's privacy at all times. Knock before entering rooms where appropriate, close curtains or doors during personal care and ensure confidential information is not discussed where others may overhear. Support people in a way that maintains their self-esteem and independence.

Autonomy

Encourage people to make their own choices wherever they are able to do so. Offer options rather than making decisions for them and support people to remain as independent as possible.

Consent

Consent must always be gained **before the commencement of any regulated activity** and throughout the visit. Never assume that consent given previously still applies. Explain what you are going to do and ensure the person agrees before providing support.

If you believe a person may lack capacity to make a specific decision, follow the Mental Capacity Act 2005 and your training. Speak to the office if you are unsure how to proceed.

Putting FREDa into practice

You should:

- Treat every person as an individual.
- Read and follow each person's care plan.
- Promote independence rather than doing tasks people can do themselves.
- Respect people's routines, preferences and decisions.
- Maintain confidentiality at all times.
- Challenge discrimination or poor practice if you witness it.
- Report any concerns where you believe a person's rights are not being upheld.

Why this matters

Embedding the FREDa principles helps us deliver truly person-centred care. It ensures the people we support are treated with kindness, compassion and respect while protecting their human rights. It also helps us meet the expectations of the Care Quality Commission (CQC) and demonstrates our commitment to providing safe, effective, caring, responsive and well-led services.

Thank you for your continued commitment to providing high-quality care. If you have any questions about the FREDa principles or how they apply to your role, please speak to the office.